

THE NOHO RAG: EPISODE 202

Written by

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First Draft
December 11, 2015

INT. WRITER'S ROOM

Bob flips through binders. Shifts boxes from cubby hole to cubby hole. Paces. Scratches his head. Then looks over to the desk on the other side of the room.

Sitting lifelessly, OLIVIA stares blankly at Bob.

OLIVIA
Is it five yet?

BOB
We have new anchors now, Olivia!
(beat)
They will read what you write!
(beat)
They need what you write.

OLIVIA
For once!
(beat)
You know how many segments I got on
the air with Alec?

Bob looks with a smirk to the ceiling.

BOB
I was a fan of your game boy
retrospective.

OLIVIA
One!

Bob keeps looking off to the ceiling.

BOB
(sotto)
It really was the best system.

OLIVIA
One, Bob!

Bob looks somberly back at Olivia.

BOB
Alec.
(beat)
... Kinda did all our jobs...
(beat)
So now, it's time to do the jobs we
were hired for.
(beat)
You know...
(MORE)

BOB (CONT'D)
(beat)
Getting paid for?

OLIVIA
So...
(beat)
Does this mean we can cover the
stories we want now?

BOB
Uhh...
(beat)
Sure.

Bob and Olivia nod. Olivia turns back to her desk.

BOB (CONT'D)
Just no nudity.
(beat)
Deal?

OLIVIA
At last.
(beat)
My reign begins!

SMASH TO: TITLE CARD

INT. NEWS DESK

Dane and Kelly Mae do what they came here to do. News time:

DANE
Good evening.
(beat)
I.
(beat)
Am Dane Argyle.

KELLY MAE
And I'm Kelly Mae Greenblat.
(beat)
Tonight. NoHo civilians headed out
to the polls to replace Wilson
DiNapoli, the NoHo Comptroller.
(beat)
Whom you may recall from his
expletive laden surprise
resignation a few weeks ago.
(beat)
The two candidates that received
the most votes will now face off in
the general election.
(MORE)

KELLY MAE (CONT'D)

(beat)

We go now live to the first
winner's campaign headquarters.
Where Eugene Knotts is preparing to
take the stage.

CUT TO:

INT. CAMPAIGN HEADQUARTERS - ON GREEN

EUGENE KNOTTS is half Don Knotts and half Mr. Rogers. He
stands in suit and tie and attempts to hush cheers.

He begins to remove his suit jacket and reveals a cardigan.

EUGENE

Hello, there!

(beat)

Thank you!

(beat)

Thanks everybody!

Eugene reaches off camera for a warm glass of milk.

He pulls one hand away quickly and shakes it.

EUGENE (CONT'D)

Ooh!

(beat)

Warm!

Eugene addresses the crowd.

EUGENE (CONT'D)

Well, folks!

(beat)

I'm just so happy we did it!

(beat)

We're gonna keep on pushing.

(beat)

Win this little old election right
here...

(beat)

And we're gonna clean up our town!

Audience erupts!

EUGENE (CONT'D)

Thank you, guys!

Eugene yawns endearingly.

EUGENE (CONT'D)
Ok, off to bed...

Eugene turns and walks off.

INT. NOHO STUDIOS - NEWS DESK

Two shot.

DANE
Adorable.
(beat)
And we now go to the headquarters
of the other big winner of the
evening, Blake Pearson.
(beat)
Whom you may recall spent a record
breaking amount on his runoff
campaign.

INT. CAMPAIGN HEADQUARTERS - GREEN SCREEN

Campaign headquarters is lively. Like a rave. Blake Pearson
takes the stage.

BLAKE
Whoo!
(beat)
Alright NoHo!

The audience calms.

BLAKE (CONT'D)
Everybody got your complimentary
vitamin water?
(beat)
Well, raise them high!
(beat)
For today we are victors!

Cheers.

BLAKE (CONT'D)
And don't forgot to take your
victory tote bag, graciously
provided by Fossil.
(beat)
For when you first get a day job.
(beat)
Fossil.

INT. NOHO STUDIOS - NEWS DESK

Two shot.

DANE

Kelly Mae, what exactly is a run
off election?

Kelly Mae turns, almost excited at Dane's banter ability.

KELLY MAE

Well!

(beat)

It's a preliminary election where
the two candidates who get the most
votes then move on to the general
election.

(beat)

So, we'll be seeing a lot more of
those two.

DANE

Well, that's not what I call a run
off.

KELLY MAE

Okay.

DANE

And I certainly wouldn't say I
elect for it.

KELLY MAE

Dane.

DANE

It just happens.

KELLY MAE

Okay well, from everyone here at
NoHo

DANE

Mostly after a spicy meal.

KELLY MAE

I'm Kelly Mae-

DANE

(sotto)

It **always** burns.

KELLY MAE

Greenblatt.

DANE
 And I'm Dane Argyle.
 (beat)
 Good luck. And good evening.

CUT TO:

REVERSE ANGLE OF NEWS DESK

Bob does his standard sigh of relief even though it kind of ended rocky.

Dane walks past.

DANE
 Good show everybody.
 (beat)
 Take note.
 (beat)
 That's how you tell the news.

Bob stops Dane at the end of his sentence.

BOB
 Dane.

DANE
 Yeah, Bob.

BOB
 I need to talk to you about how you tell the news.

DANE
 Great!
 (beat)
 Notes.
 (beat)
 Love it.
 (beat)
 Love it, Bob!

BOB
 Yeah, great.
 (beat)
 Please avoid colorful references to bowel movements during the sign off.
 (beat)
 Like I've told you...

DANE
Right right.
(beat)
Well, sometimes it just spills out
of me.

BOB
Yeah like that.
(beat)
No more.

DANE
10-4.

Dane walks off.

Bob shakes his head.

EXT. ALLEY BEHIND STUDIO

Kelly Mae walks to her car and begins loading it. Dane
follows shortly there after and saddles up behind her.

DANE
Great job in there.

Dane makes a check in the air.

DANE (CONT'D)
Public: Informed

Kelly Mae spins and faces Dane.

KELLY MAE
Yeah. About your regularly
unpleasant digestive issues.

DANE
Hey. Bob says adlib, I talk about
what I know.

KELLY MAE
Well, learn something else.
(beat)
Look Dane, you brought us all the
way out here.

DANE
Big Hollywood News.

KELLY MAE
North Hollywood. Not Hollywood.
Which I'm quickly learning are two
strikingly different places.

DANE
Still a step up from Des Moines.

KELLY MAE
I was perfectly happy there.

Kelly points at Dane and presses her index finger into his chest.

KELLY MAE (CONT'D)
You, if you recall, gave a drunken
and damned convincing call to
arms...

Dane looks off to the horizon proudly.

KELLY MAE (CONT'D)
That I even agreed to uproot my
life in Des Moines.

Dane scoffs.

DANE
Life in Des Moines?
(beat)
Look, Leon left you two years ago.
(beat)
Since then, how often have you
broken off plans after work for a
night of white wine and xanax?

Dane grabs Kelly Mae's arms.

DANE (CONT'D)
And we're here!

Dane swings to Kelly Mae's side throws one arm over her shoulder and reaches out his free hand to the horizon.

DANE (CONT'D)
One step closer.
(beat)
Big.
(beat)
Hollywood.
(beat)
News.

Kelly Mae concedes.

KELLY MAE

Well, it **is** warmer here than Iowa.
(beat)

And there **is** a damn good pie shop
two blocks from my apartment.

DANE

Oh yeah! We should go! Their
crumble crust agrees with me.

KELLY MAE

That must feel weird for you...

DANE

Yeah, with that pie it's more
wiping instead of drying.

Fade to black.